NEWS OF THE INDUSTRY

Chronicle of Important Events and General Activities in the Technical, Commercial and Manufacturing Fields

UTILITIES PLANNING TO GIVE MAXIMUM NATIONAL SERVICE

It Is Understood That Heads of Important Interests Are Studying Arrangements to Secure Most Efficient Results

The ELECTRICAL WORLD understands arrangements are being studied by the heads of important utility interests as to how to secure to the government the most efficient utilization of the resources of the utilities engaged in public service in men and facilities which they command and at the same time provide for the continued and uninterrupted operation of the plants which are so necessary to the maximum output that is an essential part of the industries contributory to the manufacture of the munitions and supplies of all kinds vital to the proper conduct of war.

Advantage will no doubt be taken of the experience had in Great Britain along similar lines so as to avoid duplication of effort and some of the mistakes which were made early in the war by the British government in its relation to the utilities and which in the early stages of the war seriously crippled the conduct of the utilities and the intensive co-operation which they were later able to afford in the general co-ordination of industrial activities.

ELECTRIC RATES RISE WITH COAL IN FALL RIVER, MASS.

Electric Company Advances Power Rates to Conform to Higher Cost of Fuel—Graduated Scale for Future

The Fall River (Mass.) Electric Light Company has made an increase in power rates based on the high cost of coal and graduated on the basis of 1 mill increase per kilowatt-hour for every dollar of coal cost to the company above $4 per ton.

In introducing the new schedule the company pointed out that its policy consistently has been to base power rates upon a small margin of profit and that rates have been reduced from time to time as conditions have warranted.

Since Jan. 1, 1916, the cost of coal to the company has increased nearly 100 per cent, and it has been obliged to contract on this basis for the coming year's supply. A notice to customers states that in the manufacturing cost of electricity coal is the principal item and last year represented 70 per cent of the cost of generation.

"Every dollar of increase in the cost of coal over $4 per ton," the company says, "represents an increased cost to the company of approximately 1 mill on every kilowatt-hour generated or sold. Our present power rates were figured and adopted when coal was $3.50 per ton, and we have assumed a coal cost of $4 per ton before increasing our present rate. Owing to the abnormal prevailing conditions, which include not only the high cost of coal but also material, apparatus and labor, we feel that it is necessary and justified to increase our present power rate on the basis of 1 mill per kilowatt-hour per dollar increase in the cost of coal above $4 per ton.

"We believe and sincerely hope that these extreme prices are temporary, and wish to assure you that we will restore our present rates immediately on the return of coal prices to their original normal figures. Based on the price of coal for the coming year the increased cost will be between 2.75 and 3 mills per kilowatt-hour. This increase will go into effect and be figured on all bills rendered on and after July 1 next."

NIKOLA TESLA IS AWARDED THE EDISON MEDAL BY A. I. E. E.

"Meritorious Achievements in His Early Original Work in Polyphase and High-Frequency Currents" to Be Honored on May 18

The seventh Edison medal, which was awarded to Nikola Tesla on Dec. 13, 1916, "for meritorious achievements in his early original work in polyphase and high-frequency electric currents," will be presented to Mr. Tesla at the annual meeting of the American Institute of Electrical Engineers in the auditorium of the Engineering Societies Building, 29 West Thirty-ninth Street, New York, on Friday evening, May 18, 1917, at 8.30 p. m. Ladies are invited to attend this meeting.

President H. W. Buck will preside, and addresses will be made by Dr. A. E. Kennelly, chairman of the Edison medal committee; Charles A. Terry, New York, and B. A. Behrend, Boston.

HISTORY OF THE EDISON MEDAL

The Edison medal was established upon the initiative of a group of friends and associates of Thomas A. Edison for the purpose of recounting and celebrating the achievements of a quarter of a century in the art of electric lighting, with which the name of Edison is imperishably identified. It was decided that the most effective means of accomplishing this object would be by the establishment of a gold medal which during the centuries to come should serve as an honorable incentive to scientists, engineers and artisans to maintain by their works a high standard of accomplishment.

The Edison medal was therefore established and endowed with a trust fund, under an indenture dated Feb. 11, 1904, whereby the A. I. E. E. agreed to award the medal annually. The medal is awarded each year by a committee consisting of twenty-four members of the Institute to a resident of the United States of America or its dependencies, or of Canada, "for meritorious achievement in electrical science or electrical engineering or the electrical arts."